

ISCEST NEWS

is produced quarterly.

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ISCEST NEWS

Issue 3

September 2024

ISCEST Invited to Partner with Pan-Ijaw Economic Summit

The first Pan-Ijaw Economic Summit will take place from 3rd - 5th December, 2024, at the Ncdmb Conference Centre, Ox-Bow Lake, Yenagoa, Bayelsa State. The theme of the event is *Environmental Regeneration and Economic Sustainability*.

The Azaiki Foundation, which was established in 2012, purposes to provide support in building a more educated, egalitarian, and responsive society. It is the bedrock of the Pan Ijaw Economic Summit, but operates with a number of stakeholders and partners, including the Azaiki Library, the Federal Ministry of Environment, the Ijaw Peoples' Congress of Canada, the Ijaw Peoples' Organisation of Germany, the National Think Tank of Nigeria and other global partners. ISCEST therefore considers it an honour to be invited to partner with the Pan Ijaw Economic Summit in hosting its first summit. ISCEST views its partnership with the Pan Ijaw Economic Summit as an opportunity to engage in meaningful discussions and debate that will address strategies that will promote and sustain socio-economic development. See the invitation letter on p.8.

The 4th Pre-Summit Conference was held 11th September, 2024 at the Azaiki Library. See pages 4 & 5.



Professor Steve Azaiki OON



Professor Nedie Akani ISCEST President

Publish Your Research Paper in CSCEST!

Current Studies in Comparative Education, Science and Technology (CSCEST) is ISCEST's Official Journal. The journal promotes interdisciplinary studies in education, science and technology. It publishes original research and papers that discuss, analyse or evaluate policies, or those that disclose relevant gaps in existing research. For more information on paper submission please visit <http://www.journal.iscest.org/>.



Abstract—Keynote Speaker for Education

Title: *Adapting International Standards to National education Agendas: The Role of Policy Translation*

Dr Elizabeth Agbor Eta,
University of Helsinki, Finland



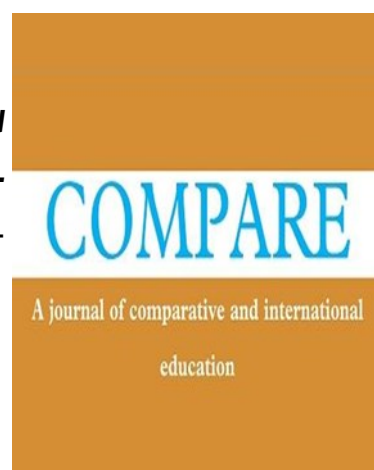
Dr Elizabeth Agbor Eta,

The keynote presentation draws from policy borrowing literature within comparative and international education research, demonstrating how national and local policy actors justify adopting global policies by invoking the ‘international standard’ as an external tool for monitoring and legitimization in international and national agenda setting in education. It also shows that the international standard motive often influences only the agenda-setting phase of the policy process, as policy actors are not passive agents in what they borrow. Through policy translation processes, national policymakers selectively borrow, consciously adapting global policies to their local contexts and attaching local meanings that align with their education priorities and agendas. Using the European Bologna process as an example, the presentation illustrates how adapting a global policy occurs in an African national context, highlighting how local actors justify such adaptations. Ultimately, the presentation emphasizes that while national education policy actors may demonstrate an awareness of global policies, practices are interpreted within their local contexts. Thus, policymakers ‘think globally but act locally.’

Check It Out!

An article co-authored by Dr Elizabeth Eta.— ***Constructed World Culture Instruments for European Higher Education Area Global Diffusion***, in *Compare: A Journal of Comparative and International Education*. Read the full article here:

<https://www.tandfonline.com/eprint/X7QQYTVJQFV8XNDSH4Q/full?target=10.1080/03057925.2024.2314020>



Abstract—Keynote Speaker for Science

Title: ***Rethinking the National in Comparative Education***

David A. Turner

Institute of International and Comparative Education, Beijing Normal University, University of South Wales

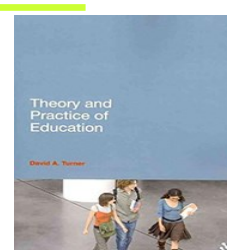


Professor David Turner

It is important to note that the word “national” occurs twice in the theme of this conference, as part of “nationalising” and as part of “international”. That seems reason enough to focus on what we mean by “national”, and what constitutes a nation. In the 1960s the answer to the question of what makes a nation seemed relatively straightforward; a nation was made up of people who shared a great deal in common. They shared language, religion, history, territory, race, and possibly other ideals. And nation-building generally involved identifying and emphasising those elements that were held in common, especially through language policy and the teaching of history. Although that approach persists in some more conservative quarters, in the form of “nationality tests”, it is practically impossible, today, to maintain that a nation has to have a corpus of traits that are common to all citizens. With increased mobility and the rise of multiculturalism, there are no countries that embody such a rigid homogeneity. In truth, there never were those ideal nations of uncontested language, religion, history and so on. Although the countries of western Europe may have pretended to be such mono-cultures, it is not possible to look at, say, the Soviet Union, Nigeria, South Africa, Brazil, Malaysia, or India, and maintain that uniformity is a necessity for nationhood. And, yet, we have not seen any serious attempt to re-imagine the meaning of nationhood in an age of diversity. We have certainly seen attempts to dismiss nationhood as irrelevant in this age of internationalism and cosmopolitanism, but no serious attempt to understand how the sum of diverse individuals can add up to something as mysterious and complex as a nation. In this paper I wish to examine a number of aspects of what it means for a group of people to constitute a nation, starting with the question of why the idea of a nation is still important in this age of fluid borders, common culture, and world citizenship.

Check It Out!

Theory and Practice of Education by Professor David Turner.



Abstract—Keynote Speaker for Technology

Development of a Framework for Integrating Artificial Intelligence into Primary and Secondary School Education Systems

Prof. Samuel Ndueso John

Nigerian Defence Academy, Kaduna
samuel.john@nda.edu.ng



Professor Samuel John

Development of a Framework for Integrating Artificial Intelligence into Primary and Secondary School Education Systems

Abstract: As the global social economy rapidly evolves, artificial intelligence (AI) has emerged as a transformative technology with widespread applications across multiple fields. In the context of the Fourth Industrial Revolution, there is a growing need to integrate AI into primary and secondary education to prepare students for future workforce demands. Embracing AI in education is not just a technical administration, it is a step towards building a more equitable and progressing society. While recent advancements have been made in computer education, there remains a gap in effective methods for incorporating AI concepts that enhance both technical competencies and cognitive abilities in young learners. This paper addresses this gap by proposing a framework for integrating AI into educational curricula, focusing on strategies that are engaging, age-appropriate, and designed to foster higher-order thinking skills. The framework was developed through teacher training programs, student workshops, and pilot implementations in various educational settings. The results demonstrate that AI can be successfully taught to younger learners, significantly improving their concepts as a foundation for getting them ready for technology-driven in the rapidly changing world. Furthermore, the framework will contribute to the development of effective AI education practices in primary and secondary schools, closing the gap between current educational approaches. Integrating AI capabilities enables the teachers to enhance their teaching methods, provide better support to students and manage their time more effectively.

Check It Out!



Check out this paper by Prof. Samuel Ndueso John.

Optic Fibericity - The New Era Lighting

NITDA Launches Initiative to Promote Digital Education

First published on 16th July 2024

By Justice Okamgba

The National Information Technology Development Agency has launched the 'Digital Literacy for All' initiative, aimed at bridging the digital divide in Nigeria.

The agency said in a statement obtained on Sunday that the initiative aligned with President Bola Ahmed Tinubu's priority to reform the economy for sustained inclusive growth.

The "Digital Literacy for All" initiative sought to ensure that every Nigerian has access to digital literacy, ensuring no one is left behind in our rapidly evolving digital world.

"This initiative is strategically designed to propel Nigeria towards a mid-term target of achieving 70 per cent digital literacy level by 2027," NITDA highlighted.

It explained that the initiative aimed to equip individuals with the necessary tools to access and utilise online resources for education, employment, and government services safely.

According to the agency, participants will learn to protect themselves online from cyber threats and misinformation, communicate and collaborate effectively using digital tools, and develop the digital fluency required for many in-demand jobs.

It added that a lack of internet access is a core driver of the digital divide in Nigeria, creating inequalities in access to information, services, and opportunities between those connected and unconnected to the digital world.

A Groupe Special Mobile Association report revealed that about 71 per cent of Nigerians do not have regular access to mobile Internet.

The GSMA stated that Nigeria could add 15 million additional internet users by 2028 with the right policy environment to address the challenges limiting telecom coverage expansion.

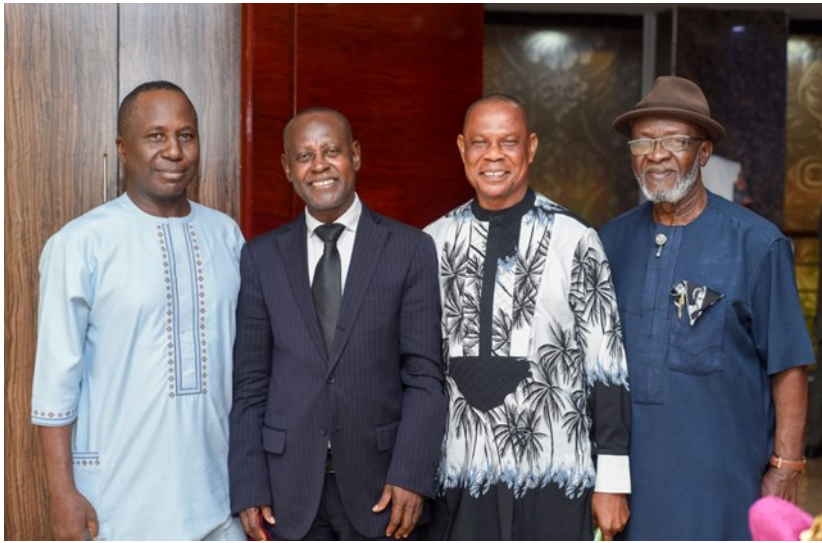
Nigeria requires over N15tn to bridge its digital infrastructure gap, according to the Association of Telecommunications Companies of Nigeria.

To narrow the digital disparity and enhance connectivity nationwide, the Nigerian government has formed a strategic partnership with the World Bank to bridge the digital gap.

Source: <https://punchng.com/nitda-launches-initiative-to-promote-digital-education/>



Some Pre-Summit Moments (From Page 1)



L-R: Prof Steve Azaiki; Prof. Thomas Commander; Chief Bello Idesi; Barrister Timothy Ogbotobo



Dr Godric Deinduomo & Engr Charles Ambaiowei



Professor Thomas Commander stressing a point at the Yenagoa meeting

The function of education is to teach one to think intensively and to think critically. Intelligence plus character — that is the goal of true education -
Martin Luther King



Education is the passport to the future, for tomorrow belongs to those who prepare for it today -
Malcolm X.4

Some Pre-Summit Moments (From Page 1)



Dr Godric Doduomo & ISCEST Representative



Above & Below: A cross-section of pre-summit participants



Those people who develop the ability to continuously acquire new and better forms of knowledge that they can apply to their work and to their lives will be the movers and shakers in our society for the indefinite future - Brian Tracy.



The great aim of education is not knowledge, but action - Herbert Spencer.

Invitation Letter (From Page 1)



PAN-IJAW ECONOMIC SUMMIT



Abuja: House B4 , No 7 Gana Street, Maitama, Abuja, FCT. Tel: +2348034632325 email: panijaweconomicsummit@gmail.com

Yenagoa: Azaiki Public Library, Plot 01, General Azazi Road, Off Imgbi Road, Yenagoa, Bayelsa State

20th August, 2024

Professor Nedie Akani, President, International Society Of Comparative Education Science & Technology (ISCEST) Nigeria Rivers State University, Port Harcourt.

Our Dear Professor Nedie Akani

FIRST PAN-IJAW ECONOMIC SUMMIT: REQUEST FOR PARTNERSHIP

We bring you warm compliments of the Azaiki Foundation and its global partners, and wish to respectfully invite you to partner with us in hosting the above summit, which aims at promoting the unity and economic well-being of Ijaw nation.

2. The summit with the theme: *Environmental Regeneration and Economic Sustainability* is organised by the Azaiki Foundation, a not-for-profit educational and socio-economic organization in collaboration with the Ijaw National Congress (INC) and the Centre for Niger Delta Research and Documentation of the Institute of Science and Technology, Yenagoa. The foundation supports Government Initiatives, Communities, Organisations, Think Tanks, Universities and Institutes that provide solutions to educational and socio-economic well-being of the people. The organisers are conversant with the issues affecting the Ijaw people such as environmental pollution, loss of farmland and aquatic life, fauna and flora, pipeline leakages, gas flaring, bunkering activities, etc. These issues have negatively affected the economic fortunes of the Ijaw people.

3, The summit is carefully designed to provide a platform to activate conversations, plans, and actions that will harness various strengths, and strategise towards the socio-economic development of the people. The summit also hopes to help in reversing the decades-long trajectory of underdevelopment and environmental degradation of the entire Niger Delta and giving the Ijaws a better stake in the Nigeria project. It promises to be an assemblage of distinguished and illustrious sons and daughters of the Ijaws. The opening ceremony will feature eminent personalities across the world to share perspectives and thoughts on the roadmap to socio-economic growth and development.

4. We are bringing together prominent stakeholders across the nation, including top Government officials, traditional rulers, captains of industry, representatives of youth and women groups, academics, professionals, and activists. Participants will be drawn from Ijaw communities in the six states of Akwa Ibom, Bayelsa, Delta, Edo, Ondo, and Rivers. Resource persons will be those who have proven themselves in the relevant fields of the theme.

(Cont'd on Page 9)

Invitation Letter (Cont'd from Page 8)

In addition to consulting you, we have held wide-ranging consultations with critical stakeholders including Governors, Members of the National Assembly, Federal officials, National Security Adviser (NSA), Elder Statesmen, Traditional Rulers, the Leadership of the Ijaw National Congress and the Ijaw Youth Council, Business Leaders, and other Critical Stakeholders. These consultations are ongoing with meetings scheduled with various Ijaw Diaspora Communities to galvanise their participation.

Beyond these consultative meetings, Pre-Summit activities have been scheduled to hold between September to November in Yenagoa, Warri, Port Harcourt, Lagos, Benin-Akure, and Abuja to concretise plans for the summit as well as sensitize the public. The pre-summit activities will include a summit on 17th October 2024 at the Azaiki Public Library, Yenagoa that will be a prelude to the summit. The summit holds from 3rd to 5th December 2024 at the Atlantic Hall of the Hotel Presidential, 1 Birabi Street, Port Harcourt - Aba Expressway, Port Harcourt, Rivers State. It will also avail the organisers the opportunity to showcase the Ijaw cultural heritage and hospitality in songs, dances, drama, and other performances as well as local cuisines. We hope that at the end of the summit, there will be a blueprint of short-term, mid-term, and long-term developmental agenda for the transformation of the Ijaw people and the Niger Delta.

Your Excellencies and distinguished guests will be treated to a formal dinner on the night of the opening ceremony where as a tradition of the Azaiki Foundation, eminent personalities and individuals who have excelled in their areas of chosen endeavors will be recognised and honoured.

As one who is conversant with issues of development, especially the peculiarities of the Niger Delta and its environs, we believe that your patriotism and commitment to the overall development and progress of Nigeria will be a compelling reason for your participation and contribution of intellectual resources towards the success of the summit.

Whilst looking forward to your kind consideration and partnership, please accept the assurances of our highest respect and regards for your person and office.

Sincerely Yours,

Prof. Steve S. Azaiki, OON
Principal Summit Convener



***Many ideas grow better
when transplanted into
another mind than the
one where they sprang
up- -Oliver Wendell
Holmes.***



Professor Wegwu's Address (Cont'd from ISCEST News Issue 2)



Professor Matthew Wegwu

These policies that are alien to modern civilization have inadvertently encouraged crass mediocrity as persons who lack the requisite basic qualifications (i.e M.Sc. Biochemistry) currently head Medical Biochemistry Departments and teach the subject in Nigerian universities.

May I remind the leadership of the two sister Associations that whereas their works are observatory, ours are investigatory. For further clarification: when a medical practitioner observes the presence and abnormal activity of a deviant protein, our function as explorers of life processes is to investigate the gene that expressed the protein. We truly do not need walls that separate us, but bridges that would enhance collaborations among scholars, especially, in a time like this when our hospitals are inundated with young people with varied forms of nephrotic and/ or hepatic malfunctions. In my view, the creative and sustainable solution to this seemingly intractable problem is collaborative teaching that allows medically qualified personnel with basic background in Biochemistry and certified Biochemists to jointly teach courses in Biochemistry, such as enzymology, endocrine biochemistry, and metabolism of nucleic acids, among others. May I passionately appeal to the National Universities Commission (NUC), the National Assembly, Committee of Vice- Chancellors and well-meaning Nigerians to quickly intervene and resolve this matter.

Fellow academics, it is with a deep sense of humility that I wish to remind us that one of the cardinal objectives for establishing tertiary educational institutions is to contribute to local and national development through research that ignites creativity and innovation. For instance, from 1996 to 2015, technology transfer from universities in the United States of America sparked development of over 380,000 new inventions, and contributed 591 billion US dollars to the national Gross Domestic Product (GDP), and supported 4.3 million jobs.

Similarly, universities in nearby Ghana contributed about 1.1 billion US dollars to the country's GDP. One available record suggests that in 2010 alone, the education sector in Nigeria contributed about 827 million naira to the national GDP. As captains of the brain industry, I am confident that we can contribute to the speedy realization of President Bola Ahmed Tinubu's *Renewed Hope Agenda* by unveiling high impact research products that meet international acceptance and local relevance. Indeed, now is the time to engage in researches whose anticipated products would inspire innovations that are patentable and marketable in technology incubation parks, and publishable in world-class, peer-review journals.

Mr. Chairman, Royal Father, Distinguished guests, fellow researchers, ladies and gentlemen, permit me to end by paraphrasing Astrophysicist, Carl Sagan: we can make Nigeria stand out in the comity of nations through the courage of our research questions and the impeccable depth of our research findings.

I wish all participants a successful and fulfilling experience in this Scientific Conference and Annual General Meeting of NSBMB.

Professor Matthew Wegwu

President, NSBMB.

Attend International Education Conferences!



Envisioning Education in a Digital
Society CIES 2025
Annual Conference Chicago, IL
March 22-26, 2025

ICEDU 2025

The 11th International Conference on Education 2025

Theme: “Cultivating Global Citizen Skills through Research
and Education: Development of critical thinking, creativity,
communication and collaboration”

April 07th – 09th, 2025
Bangkok, Thailand



ICSEI Congress 2025

Redefining Education:
Purpose and Possibilities

February 10-14, 2025

ICSEI 2025 Congress Venue – [The University of Melbourne](https://www.unimelb.edu.au/)

The 21st Biennial Conference of the International Study
Association on Teachers & Teaching

University of Glasgow, 30 June - 4 July 2025



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Check our website!
www.istyenagoa.ng



Another Conference Reminder!

All those who are planning to present a paper for the 10th Anniversary Conference are reminder that you have a choice of three broad themes—Science, Education and Technology. Within these broad themes, there are many areas from which you can choose to develop your paper.

The choice is very wide! Personal experiences can also be an area for selection. The settings for the papers can be at institutional, community, national, regional or international level. In every instance, there is scope for comparative perspectives. Presenters, do not miss this opportunity to tell others about your teaching and learning experiences.



Professor Nedie Akani

Abstracts should be sent to: iscestnigeria@gmail.com

Deadline for submission of Abstracts: **30th October 2024**

Abstract acceptance notification: **15th November 2024**

Abstracts should be sent electronically to: Editors@iscest.org

Just a Word of Appreciation!



*Some people take for granted
The many things you do
They often forget to show
That they appreciate you*

*All the help that people give
We do well to remember
To duly acknowledge them
On the appreciation agenda*

Gertrude Shotte